

Chapter 101 - The Last Day

Yan Lin stayed up all night at the company. It wasn't until five in the morning the next day that she lay down for a short rest on the small bed in the break room.

Mo Yi Xu was given the morning off by Yan Lin that day, with instructions to come back in the afternoon to take over some matters.

Yan Lin slept for three hours in the break room, then woke up to one meeting after another.

During Yan Lin's time abroad, all affairs had been handled by Chang Ya, Mo Yi Xu, and the company's vice president, while Yan Lin's father only ensured the company's overall direction stayed on track.

So Yan Lin pushed herself very hard, finishing all meetings by morning and distributing all subsequent work arrangements, appearing extremely like a slave-driving boss¹.

After the meetings ended, Chang Ya and the company vice president discussed coming to ask their boss if something had happened - why was she pushing everyone so hard?

Chang Ya spent more time by Yan Lin's side usually, so this task fell to her.

Yan Lin sat in her office, frowning as she looked at reports submitted by the finance department. When she heard knocking, she didn't look up but just responded, "Come in."

Chang Ya came in and carefully closed the door. "President Yan."

"Chang Ya, you came at just the right time. I have several things to instruct you on." Yan Lin took off the blue light glasses from her nose bridge and pushed a stack of file folders forward. "These projects are ones the company must secure within the next ten years of development. I'm now entrusting all subsequent follow-up to you."

"Ten... ten years?" Chang Ya hadn't expected that wanting to show concern for her superior would result in receiving a pile of work. "President Yan, many of these projects don't have much progress yet, right? And... all of this for just me alone?"

Yan Lin nodded. "Mm, don't worry about the projects without progress for now. Start following up on those that show promise. This might look like a lot, but there's no time pressure - you can take it slowly."

"As for Assistant Mo, don't worry - he won't have it easier than you."

Chang Ya took a deep breath. "President Yan, honestly I don't understand the purpose of all this. And the work assigned in today's meetings - isn't it a bit too intense? What you're doing especially looks like... like you're planning to abscond with funds." And it also looked like arranging final affairs.

However, Chang Ya didn't voice that last sentence.

Hearing her say this, Yan Lin slightly lowered her gaze and put down what was in her hands. "Chang Ya, the company will be entrusted to you three from now on. As for who will take my position, I'll find a professional manager when the time comes. Plus with my father overseeing the board of directors, the company won't have any problems."

Chang Ya's expression changed. She never expected Yan Lin to say such things. "President Yan, you —"

"Chang Ya, only you in the entire company know about this matter now. In the future, please take care of everything."

So when the vice president saw Chang Ya afterward, she looked gloomy with a very ugly expression.

Chang Ya was still holding that stack of file folders. She walked up to the vice president and shook her head. "The company is about to change hands."

She didn't say anything more, just left the vice president completely confused and then continued back to work with a worried frown.

While Yan Lin was busy all day, Feng Yue wasn't much more idle.

Early in the morning, she had appointments with her personal financial advisor and personal lawyer.

"I've asked you both here today because I want to settle my assets in advance and do asset allocation."

The financial advisor nodded and spread out all the documents and materials he had prepared in front of Feng Yue.

She had started investing after graduation. Although she hadn't made huge profits, she had almost never suffered losses, so her assets increased every year. Combined with her real estate holdings, Feng Yue was truly a wealthy woman.

Feng Yue had no children and no spouse, so she left most of these assets to her parents, with the remainder donated to charity foundations, mainly to help girls in impoverished areas.

After handling all this, they had spent over three hours.

After the financial advisor and lawyer left, Feng Yue received a call from Yan Lin.

"Hello."

"Ah Yue, are you free now? I'll come pick you up for a meal."

Feng Yue touched her indeed somewhat hungry stomach and agreed. Soon, Yan Lin's familiar car stopped in front of the café.

Yan Lin picked her up and had the driver take them directly to a restaurant.

Their relationship now couldn't be called particularly good, but they still had the friendship to care about each other with a word or two. So when Feng Yue saw the obvious dark circles under Yan Lin's eyes, she asked, "Didn't you sleep well last night?"

"Mm, there are quite a few company matters since I just returned, and the handover work is also quite troublesome."

Feng Yue fell silent. She understood very clearly what Yan Lin meant by "handover work."

"Yan Lin, you don't need to do this..." Because there was still a driver in front, Feng Yue couldn't speak too directly.

But Yan Lin wouldn't listen to these words at all. "I followed you to come here. When you leave, I naturally have to follow too."

Yan Lin's voice was very low. "I will never be separated from you again."

After Yan Lin said this, the car fell into silence. It wasn't until they arrived at the restaurant and began ordering that they started talking again, just never mentioning what was said in the car.

After the meal, Yan Lin drove Feng Yue home. Before getting out of the car, Yan Lin grabbed Feng Yue's wrist and said softly, "I'll come pick you up for dinner tonight, okay?"

Feng Yue was silent for a while, then nodded.

Until Yan Lin's car drove out of the villa area, Feng Yue never withdrew her gaze.

As time drew closer, Feng Yue's nerves became increasingly taut. She said she no longer cared about this matter, but she was afraid of the impact this would have on her family.

So every time she faced her parents, she would put on an appearance of complete normalcy, but her heart was full of guilt and pain, with enormous psychological pressure.

But during the time she spent with the informed party Yan Lin, she didn't need to pretend at all. She could show her truest emotions and completely relax her mind.

So she became greedy for the time spent with her, that relaxation and ease was what she needed.

In the evening, Yan Lin came to pick up Feng Yue for dinner as agreed. When they left, Jiang Yu even teased them for a while.

However, this time Yan Lin didn't bring a driver but drove herself, and the direction wasn't toward the city.

"Where are we going?"

Yan Lin smiled. "You'll know in a bit."

Feng Yue knew she wouldn't get an answer, so she stopped asking and just occasionally looked out the car window curiously.

But watching the increasingly familiar scenery, the confusion on her face grew deeper.

Until the car stopped in front of a small villa, Feng Yue's face showed a dazed expression.

Yan Lin had brought her back to their former home.

Lights were on in the villa, clearly indicating someone was living there.

Yan Lin got out to open the car door for her, gently taking her hand to lead her out. "Mama Liu has already prepared dinner. Shall we go in?"

Since Yan Lin had said this much, Feng Yue couldn't very well turn around and leave, though returning here now did make her feel somewhat different.

The two opened the door and went in. Mama Liu was busy in the kitchen. Hearing the door open, she poked her head out with a spatula. "You two are back. There are just two more dishes to go - please sit in the living room for a bit."

Feng Yue was led inside by Yan Lin. Nothing had changed - it was still all the things Feng Yue had arranged with her own hands, and Mama Liu had also kept the house spotlessly clean.

Yan Lin watched Feng Yue's expressionless appearance and felt somewhat nervously anxious. She was afraid Feng Yue was angry, and afraid she blamed her for being presumptuous.

But apart from looking around at the house's furnishings, Feng Yue didn't show any of her emotions.

After Mama Liu finished cooking all the dishes, she left the villa, though she did chat with Feng Yue for a bit before leaving.

Feng Yue sat at the dining table, silently eating Mama Liu's cooking, her expression somewhat dazed.

Only after swallowing that bite of food did she say, "The taste is still the same."

"Ah Yue, I still want to have meals at home together like this with you."

Feng Yue looked up in confusion.

"Shall we go to the hospital once more tomorrow?" Yan Lin's voice was somewhat hoarse, with a hint of pleading in her tone.

Feng Yue looked at her, understanding that Yan Lin didn't want to give up. But Feng Yue herself understood that her death was destined - she could already feel it.

This was a very mysterious feeling, not caused by physical discomfort anywhere, but a sensitivity to death rising from the bottom of her heart.

Feng Yue understood all this, but in the end she still nodded and agreed to Yan Lin's request. This wasn't just for Yan Lin, but also for her parents who would learn of her death.

So the next afternoon, Yan Lin took Feng Yue to see Professor Fang again. After the examination, Professor Fang gave them very good news.

Feng Yue's body was very healthy, and her brain condition was gradually improving. As long as she continued treatment, she would definitely recover.

Yan Lin sat in the car holding Feng Yue's medical report, speechless and motionless, while Feng Yue sat in the passenger seat beside her.

"Please take me home," Feng Yue said softly.

Yan Lin was pulled back to her senses by her voice. After wiping her face, she forced a smile. "Look, the examination results are very good. Maybe you won't be the same as in your previous life at all." With that, she threw the medical report into the back seat and ignored it.

Feng Yue remained silent, just looking at Yan Lin wordlessly.

Yan Lin couldn't say anything more either. She turned the key to start the car, stepped on the gas, and drove straight ahead.

However, Yan Lin didn't take Feng Yue home, but returned to the small villa they had just visited the night before.

This was Feng Yue's last day, and also the day all of Yan Lin's hopes completely disappeared.

Feng Yue knew Yan Lin was suffering. Yan Lin was the only person who knew everything - her pressure wasn't any less than Feng Yue's.

But Feng Yue didn't know how to comfort her.

So these two people, just like that night in the snow mountain, could only rely on each other for warmth, only rely on each other to relieve the pressure in their hearts.

After dinner, Feng Yue stood in front of the floor-to-ceiling window in the living room, watching the sun set on the horizon, bringing out a sky full of sunset clouds.

Feng Yue stood there for a long time, until not a trace of the sun could be seen on the horizon.

She turned around, revealing a smile as brilliant as sunshine, with Yan Lin's reflection in her eyes.

"Ah Lin, take me to see one more sunrise."

"Alright."

Footnotes:

¹ "Slave-driving boss" (周扒皮) - A reference to Zhou Bapi, a fictional exploitative landlord character from Chinese literature, used colloquially to describe someone who overworks their subordinates.